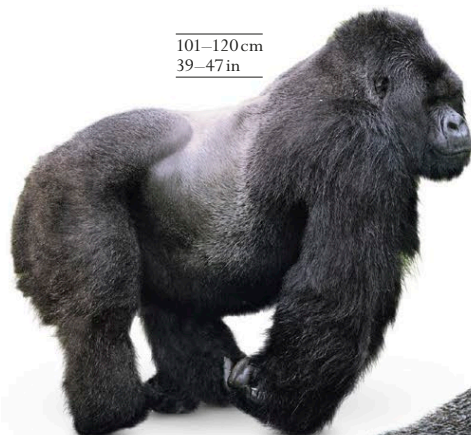


HUMANS AND APES

The family Hominidae contains the largest primates – the great apes and humans. Orangutans are arboreal, whereas chimpanzees, gorillas, and humans spend the majority of their time on the ground. Chimpanzees and gorillas move on all fours by “knuckle-walking”. None of the great apes has a tail. Males are generally larger than females and all species have a relatively large braincase.

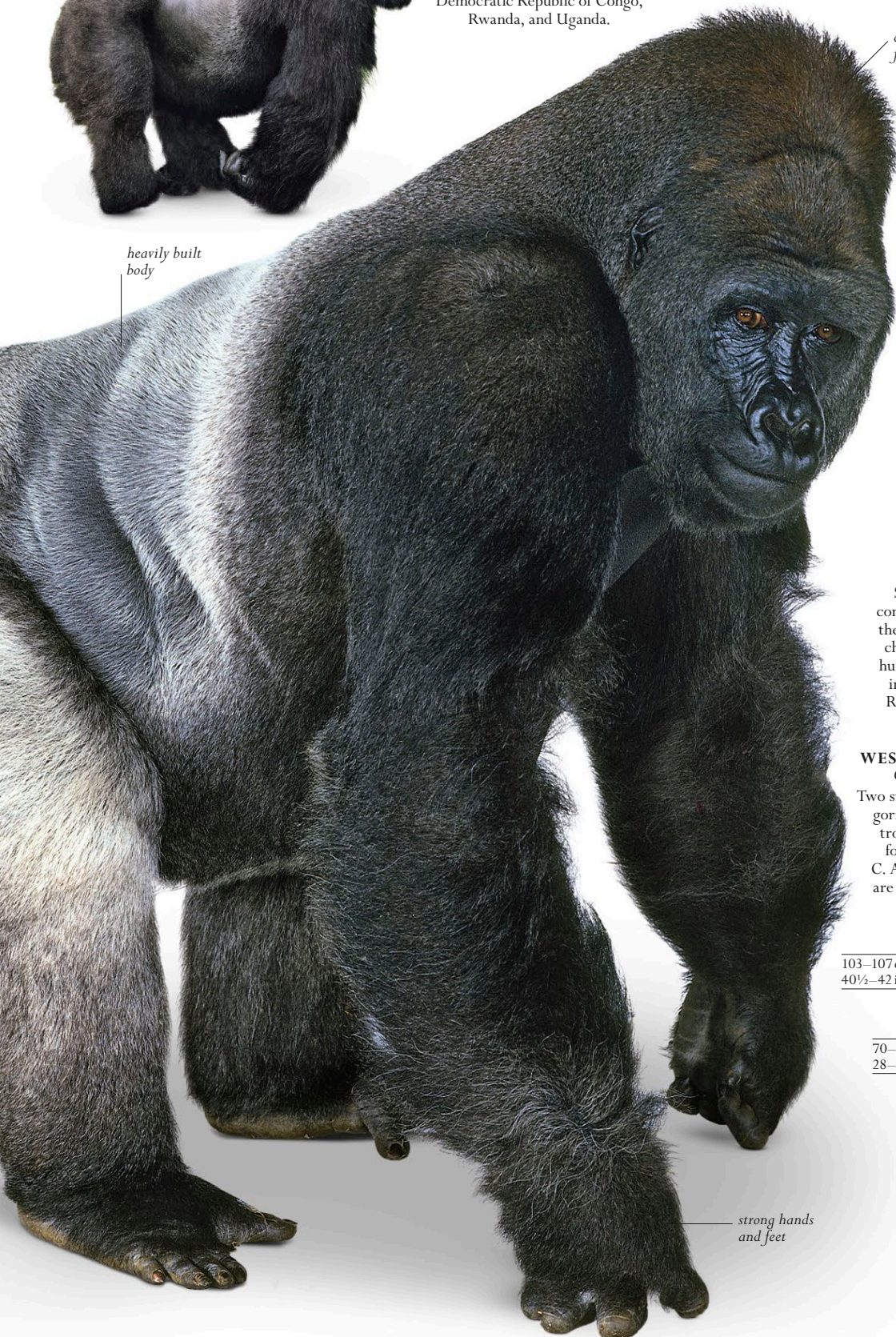


101–120 cm
39–47 in

EASTERN GORILLA *Gorilla beringei*

The largest primate, the two eastern gorilla subspecies inhabit montane cloud forest and lowland forest in the eastern Democratic Republic of Congo, Rwanda, and Uganda.

heavily built
body



domed
forehead



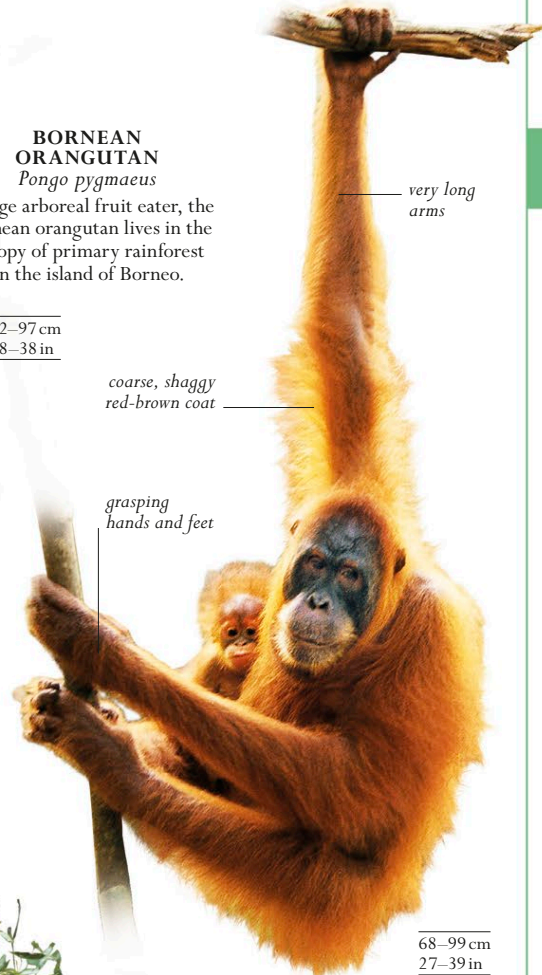
BORNEAN ORANGUTAN *Pongo pygmaeus*

A large arboreal fruit eater, the Bornean orangutan lives in the canopy of primary rainforest on the island of Borneo.

72–97 cm
28–38 in

coarse, shaggy
red-brown coat

grasping
hands and feet



very long
arms

68–99 cm
27–39 in

SUMATRAN ORANGUTAN *Pongo abelii*

The largest arboreal primate, the Sumatran orangutan is restricted to fragments of primary tropical forest in N. Sumatra.



70–83 cm
28–33 in

BONOBO *Pan paniscus*

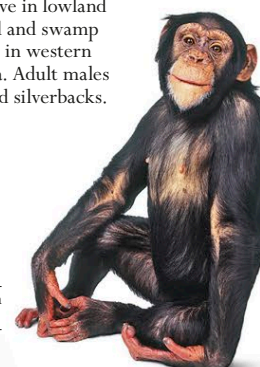
Slighter than the common chimpanzee, the bonobo or pygmy chimpanzee lives in humid tropical forest in the Democratic Republic of Congo.

WESTERN GORILLA *Gorilla gorilla*

Two subspecies of western gorilla live in lowland tropical and swamp forests in western C. Africa. Adult males are called silverbacks.

103–107 cm
40½–42 in

70–96 cm
28–38 in



COMMON CHIMPANZEE *Pan troglodytes*

Four subspecies of the common chimpanzee are distributed in dry and moist forests and savanna woodlands in equatorial Africa.

strong hands
and feet



1.2–2.1 m
4–7 ft

HUMAN *Homo sapiens*

Characterized by a bipedal posture and a lack of body hair, humans permanently inhabit every terrestrial habitat, with the exception of Antarctica.